



BCRLS CERTIFICATE COURSE

INTERNATIONAL REFUGEE LAW AND CONTEMPORARY REFUGEE CRISES

20 Topics	20 Lectures
12–14 Weeks	100-Mark Online Final Examination
Primary Case Study	Rohingya Crisis / Bangladesh

Proposed Course Structure: 20 substantive topics delivered through 20 online lectures, with interactive activities and online assessment.

Comparative crises: Syria, Afghanistan, Ukraine, Sudan, Palestine, Venezuela and others.

1. Course Overview

This proposed BCRLS certificate course is designed around 20 substantive topics delivered through 20 online lectures. It broadens the existing refugee-law module beyond the Rohingya case while retaining the Rohingya crisis as the principal Bangladesh-focused case study. Other major refugee and displacement crises are integrated comparatively to connect doctrine with contemporary practice.

Format	20 online lectures + interactive activities + online assessment
Total Topics	20
Suggested Duration	12–14 weeks
Primary Case Study	Rohingya crisis / Bangladesh
Comparative Crises	Syria, Afghanistan, Ukraine, Sudan, Palestine, Venezuela and others
Assessment	100-mark online final examination

2. Course Learning Architecture

FOUNDATIONS	STATUS	PROTECTION	RIGHTS	JUSTICE	CRISES	DURABLE SOLUTIONS	REFORM
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The course progresses from the basic concept of refugeehood and the evolution of refugee law, through status determination, non-refoulement and refugee rights, into statelessness, human rights, justice and vulnerability. It then addresses non-signatory states, protracted refugee situations, durable solutions, international responsibility and contemporary crises.

3. Topics 1–10

No.	Topic	Core Focus	Major Crisis / Case	Activity
1	What is a Refugee?	Refugee definition; refugee vs migrant; asylum seeker; IDP; 1951 Convention; 1967 Protocol; UNHCR	Rohingya; historical European development	Opening poll + timeline exercise
2	Evolution of International Refugee Law	League of Nations; 1951 Convention; 1967 Protocol; UNHCR	Post-WWII refugee crisis	Historical timeline
3	Refugee Status Determination	Well-founded fear; persecution; protected grounds; exclusion; OAU; Cartagena; EU; Asian context	Rohingya / Afghanistan; Africa & Latin America	RSD case problem + regional comparison
4	Regional Refugee Frameworks	OAU Convention; Cartagena Declaration; EU framework; Asian approaches	African and Latin American refugee movements	Regional comparison
5	Non-Refoulement	Article 33; customary law; direct and indirect refoulement; procedural safeguards	Rohingya return	Case-law analysis
6	Rights of Refugees	Civil, political, economic, social and cultural rights	Syrian refugees	Rights-mapping exercise
7	Detention, Deportation and Immigration Control	Immigration detention; deportation; pushbacks; fair procedure; legal aid; judicial review	Europe / Australia Border Control	Moot-style argument + mini hearing
8	Asylum Procedures and Access to Justice	Fair hearing; legal aid; judicial review; appeal mechanisms	European asylum system	Mock asylum hearing
9	Statelessness and Refugeehood	De jure/de facto statelessness; nationality deprivation; refugeehood	Rohingya	Legal-status analysis
10	Refugees and Human Rights Law	ICCPR, CAT, CEDAW, CRC; universality of human rights	Rohingya / Syrian refugees	Treaty application exercise

4. Topics 11–20

No.	Topic	Core Focus	Major Crisis / Case	Activity
11	Internally Displaced Persons	Refugees vs IDPs; Guiding Principles; protection gaps	Sudan / Syria	Comparative exercise
12	Gender, Children and Vulnerable Refugees	GBV; child protection; trafficking; intersectionality	Rohingya / Syria	Scenario-based discussion
13	Refugees and Criminal Justice	Victimhood; accountability; court access; community justice; mediation; hybrid systems	Rohingya camps	Justice-system simulation
14	Informal and Formal Justice	Community justice; mediation; traditional systems; formal courts	Justice mechanisms in refugee camps	Mediation role-play
15	Refugee Protection in Non-Signatory States	Customary international law; constitutional protection; state practice	Bangladesh / India / Pakistan	Comparative constitutional analysis
16	Protracted Refugee Situations	Long-term displacement; temporary protection; local integration	Rohingya / Palestinian refugees	Policy debate
17	Repatriation, Resettlement and Local Integration	Three durable solutions; voluntariness; safety; dignity	Rohingya / Syrian refugees	Durable-solutions simulation
18	Burden-Sharing and International Responsibility	Responsibility-sharing; funding; resettlement	Ukraine, Afghanistan, Sudan, Syria, Palestine, Venezuela; Bangladesh / Ukraine / global crises	International negotiation simulation
19	Contemporary Refugee Crises	Ukraine; Afghanistan; Sudan; Syria; Palestine; Venezuela	Comparative global refugee crises	Crisis comparison & presentation
20	Future of Refugee Law	Climate displacement; emerging crises; Global South perspectives; reform	Global	Final synthesis + examination briefing

5. Session Flow

Stage	Lectures	Purpose
I. Foundations	Lectures 1–2	Introduction to refugees and forced migration; refugee vs migrant vs asylum seeker vs IDP; evolution of international refugee law; 1951 Convention, 1967 Protocol and UNHCR
II. Refugee Status & Protection	Lectures 3–6	Refugee Status Determination; well-founded fear and persecution; regional refugee frameworks; non-refoulement; fundamental rights of refugees
III. Justice & Vulnerability	Lectures 7–14	Border control, detention and deportation; asylum procedures and access to justice; statelessness; human rights protection; IDPs; gender and children; criminal justice; formal and informal justice
IV. Non-Signatory & Protracted Contexts	Lectures 15–16	Refugee protection in non-signatory states; customary international law; constitutional protection; Bangladesh, India and Pakistan; challenges of protracted displacement
V. Durable Solutions	Lecture 17	Voluntary repatriation, resettlement and local integration; safety, voluntariness, dignity and long-term protection
VI. Global Responsibility & Crises	Lectures 18–19	International responsibility and burden-sharing; funding and resettlement; contemporary refugee crises including Ukraine, Afghanistan, Sudan, Syria, Palestine and Venezuela
VII. Future & Assessment	Lecture 20	International responsibility and burden-sharing; funding and resettlement; contemporary refugee crises including Ukraine, Afghanistan, Sudan, Syria, Palestine and Venezuela

6. Session and Activity Plan — Lectures 1–10

Lecture	Lecture Component	Interactive Component	Suggested Material
1	What is a refugee?	Refugee, migrant, asylum seeker and IDP; basic concepts	Opening poll: Who is a refugee? Material: 1951 Refugee Convention; UNHCR materials
2	Evolution of international refugee law	1951 Convention, 1967 Protocol and UNHCR	Refugee-law timeline exercise Material: 1951 Convention; 1967 Protocol; UNHCR
3	Refugee Status Determination	Well-founded fear, persecution, protected grounds and exclusion	Hypothetical RSD case Material: RSD guidelines; case materials
4	Regional refugee frameworks	OAU, Cartagena, EU and Asian approaches	Regional comparison exercise Material: OAU Convention; Cartagena Declaration; EU framework
5	Non-refoulement	Article 33, customary law, direct and indirect refoulement, safeguards	Case-law debate Material: M.S.S.; A. v. Australia; related cases
6	Rights of refugees	Civil, political, economic, social and cultural rights	Applicant vs State argument Material: 1951 Convention; ICCPR; ICESCR
7	Detention, deportation and border control	Pushbacks, fair procedure and judicial review	Applicant vs State arguments Material: Comparative detention and deportation cases
8	Asylum procedures and access to justice	Legal aid, appeals and judicial review	Mini asylum-hearing simulation Material: Domestic and international asylum law
9	Statelessness and refugeehood	De jure/de facto statelessness and nationality deprivation	Rohingya legal-status analysis Material: Statelessness Conventions; Rohingya case materials
10	Refugees and human rights law	ICCPR, CAT, CEDAW and CRC	Treaty-application exercise Material: ICCPR; CAT; CEDAW; CRC

6. Session and Activity Plan — Lectures 11–20

Lecture	Lecture Component	Interactive Component	Suggested Material
11	Internally Displaced Persons	Refugee–IDP distinction, Guiding Principles and protection gaps	Refugee–IDP comparison Material: UN Guiding Principles on Internal Displacement
12	Gender, children and vulnerable refugees	GBV, child protection, trafficking and intersectionality	Scenario-based discussion Material: UNHCR protection guidelines; CEDAW; CRC
13	Refugees and criminal justice	Victimhood, accountability, court access and community justice	Justice-system simulation Material: Rohingya camp justice case study
14	Informal and formal justice	Mediation, traditional/community mechanisms and hybrid justice	Mediation role-play Material: Refugee-camp justice case materials
15	Refugee protection in non-signatory states	Customary international law, constitutional protection and state practice	Comparative constitutional analysis Material: Bangladesh, India and Pakistan legal materials
16	Protracted refugee situations	Long-term displacement, temporary protection and local integration	Policy debate Material: Rohingya and Palestinian refugee case studies
17	Repatriation, resettlement and local integration	Voluntariness, safety and dignity	Durable-solutions simulation Material: Rohingya and Syrian refugee cases
18	Burden-sharing and international responsibility	Funding, resettlement and responsibility-sharing	International negotiation simulation Material: UNHCR reports; global responsibility-sharing frameworks
19	Contemporary refugee crises	Ukraine, Afghanistan, Sudan, Syria, Palestine and Venezuela	Comparative crisis presentation Material: UNHCR Global Trends; selected crisis reports
20	Future of refugee law	Climate displacement, emerging crises, Global South perspectives and legal reform	Final synthesis + examination briefing Material: All previous materials; future refugee-law literature

7. Major Refugee Crises Integrated into the Course

Crisis / Context	Main Legal Question
Rohingya / Myanmar	Refugee status, statelessness, non-refoulement, non-signatory states
Syria	Mass displacement, asylum, temporary protection, burden-sharing
Afghanistan	Non-refoulement, asylum and gender persecution
Ukraine	Temporary protection and European solidarity
Sudan	Conflict displacement, refugees and IDPs
Palestine	Protracted displacement and special refugee regimes
Venezuela	Regional protection and Cartagena framework
Africa generally	Expanded refugee definition and regional protection
Bangladesh	Non-signatory state, constitutional protection and Rohingya justice

8. Assessment Structure

The course uses a single structured online final examination as the principal summative assessment. Short online quizzes may be used formatively during the course, but the final grade is determined by the online examination.

Component	Marks	Format
MCQ	30	30 questions × 1 mark
True/False / Assertion-Reason	10	10 questions
Case-based MCQ	20	5 hypothetical cases × 4 marks
Short Analytical Questions	20	4 × 5 marks
Problem Question	20	One refugee-law hypothetical
Total	100	Online examination

Recommended examination duration: 90 minutes.

Assessment progression: Knowledge → Understanding → Application → Legal Analysis.

9. Recommended Online Activities

Activity	Timing	Purpose
Pre-class reading	Before every lecture	Build foundational knowledge
Live poll	Beginning of lecture	Test prior understanding
Case discussion	Middle of lecture	Apply legal principles
Breakout-room problem	Selected lectures	Collaborative legal reasoning
Crisis simulation	Lectures 12–14	Practical application
Online quiz	After every 2–3 lectures	Continuous formative assessment
Discussion forum	Throughout	Debate contemporary refugee issues
Final revision session	Lecture 15	Consolidate all 20 topics
Online final examination	After Lecture 15	Summative assessment

10. Overall Course Model

20 Topics	20 Lectures
12–14 Weeks	Case-Based Learning
Contemporary Crisis Analysis	Interactive Simulations
Online Formative Quizzes	100-Mark Online Final Examination

The Rohingya crisis remains the central Bangladesh case study, particularly for statelessness, non-refoulement, non-signatory states, access to justice and criminal justice, while other crises provide the comparative international dimension.